Stye & Chalazion Quick Self-Assessment

Instructions

Answer these questions to help determine if you should see a doctor or can manage your eyelid lump at home. Check the boxes that apply to you.

SECTION 1: Core Symptoms

Question 1: Do you have a bump or lump on your eyelid?

- [ ] Yes
- [ ] No

Question 2: Where is the bump located?

- [ ] On the edge of the eyelid, near the eyelashes
- [ ] Inside the eyelid (you can feel it when you close your eye or flip the lid)
- [ ] Away from the eyelid edge, deeper in the lid
- [ ] Not sure

Question 3: Is the bump painful?

- [ ] Yes, very painful and tender
- [ ] Yes, mildly uncomfortable
- [ ] No, painless
- [ ] Only hurts when I press on it

Question 4: How long have you had this bump?

- [ ] 1-3 days (just appeared)
- [ ] 4-7 days
- [ ] 1-3 weeks
- [ ] More than 1 month
- [ ] It comes and goes (recurrent)

Question 5: How fast did the bump develop?

- [ ] Appeared overnight or within 1 day
- [ ] Gradually grew over several days
- [ ] Slowly developed over 1-2 weeks
- [ ] Very slow growth over weeks to months

SECTION 2: Associated Symptoms

Question 6: Is your eyelid red and swollen?

- [ ] Yes, very red and swollen
- [ ] Yes, mildly swollen with localized redness
- [ ] No, just a firm lump with normal-looking skin
- [ ] Yes, and the redness is spreading to my cheek/eyebrow

Question 7: Do you have yellow pus or discharge?

- [ ] Yes, yellow pus at the tip of the bump
- [ ] Yes, discharge crusting on my eyelashes
- [ ] No visible pus
- [ ] Yes, and it's draining or has already drained

Question 8: Is your vision affected?

- [ ] Yes, blurry vision
- [ ] Yes, double vision
- [ ] No, vision is normal
- [ ] Only blurry when the swelling pushes on my eye

Question 9: Do you have a gritty or sandy feeling in your eye?

- [ ] Yes, feels like something is in my eye
- [ ] No

Question 10: Are you sensitive to light?

- [ ] Yes, bright light hurts my eyes
- [ ] No

SECTION 3: Medical History & Risk Factors

Question 11: Have you had styes or chalazia before?

- [ ] No, this is my first one
- [ ] Yes, once or twice before
- [ ] Yes, I get them frequently (3+ times per year)

Question 12: Do you have any of these conditions?

Check all that apply:

- [ ] Acne or rosacea
- [ ] Dandruff or seborrheic dermatitis
- [ ] Diabetes
- [ ] Weakened immune system
- [ ] Chronic dry eyes

- [ ] None of the above

Question 13: Do you wear contact lenses?

- [ ] Yes
- [ ] No

Question 14: Do you use eye makeup?

- [ ] Yes, regularly
- [ ] Yes, occasionally
- [ ] No

SECTION 4: Severity Assessment & Triage

Question 15: Do you have a fever?

- [ ] Yes, temperature above 100.4°F (38°C)
- [ ] No

Question 16: Is the swelling spreading beyond the original lump?

- [ ] Yes, entire eyelid is swollen
- [ ] Yes, swelling extending to cheek/eyebrow/other eye
- [ ] No, just localized to the bump area
- [ ] Getting worse rapidly (within hours)

SECTION 5: Treatment & Management

Question 17: Have you tried any treatments at home?

Check all that apply:

- [ ] Warm compresses
- [ ] Over-the-counter antibiotic ointment
- [ ] Pain medication
- [ ] Ice/cold compresses
- [ ] Nothing yet
- [ ] Other home remedies (tea bags, aloe vera, etc.)

Question 18: Has the bump drained (pus came out)?

- [ ] Yes, drained on its own
- [ ] Yes, I squeezed it (not recommended)
- [ ] No, still swollen and closed
- [ ] Partially drained but still swollen

Question 19: Have you seen a doctor for this?

- [ ] Yes, currently under doctor's care
- [ ] No, managing at home
- [ ] No, but planning to see doctor

Quick Decision Guide

SEEK EMERGENCY CARE IMMEDIATELY IF YOU HAVE:

- Vision changes (blurry, double vision, vision loss)
- Severe eye pain (not just eyelid discomfort)
- Severe light sensitivity with pain
- Fever above 101°F (38.3°C) with eyelid swelling
- Swelling spreading to cheek, eyebrow, or other eye
- Eye movement problems or eye bulging
- Rapidly worsening symptoms (within hours)

SEE EYE DOCTOR WITHIN 24-48 HOURS IF:

- You wear contact lenses and have any eyelid infection
- Thick pus discharge or very sticky eyelids
- Stye not improving after 5-7 days of warm compresses
- Chalazion not improving after 2-3 weeks
- You get styes or chalazia frequently (3+ times per year)
- Eyelid lump lasting more than 1 month
- You have weakened immune system or diabetes
- Moderate light sensitivity
- Vision slightly blurry from large lump

HOME MANAGEMENT IS APPROPRIATE IF:

- Typical painful stye (red bump on eyelid edge, less than 5 days)
- Typical painless chalazion (firm lump, less than 2 weeks)
- No warning signs (normal vision, no fever, no spreading)
- Symptoms improving with warm compresses
- First occurrence, not recurrent
- Not a contact lens wearer

Home Care Instructions

If home management is appropriate, follow these steps:

Warm Compresses (Most Important Treatment)

1. Wash hands thoroughly
2. Soak clean washcloth in warm water (test temperature on wrist)
3. Wring out excess water
4. Apply to closed eyelid for 10-15 minutes
5. Reheat cloth when it cools (every 2-3 minutes)

6. Repeat 4-6 times daily
7. After compress, gently massage bump toward eyelid edge

Additional Care

- Clean eyelid gently with diluted baby shampoo or lid wipes
- Take ibuprofen or acetaminophen for pain if needed
- Discontinue eye makeup until healed
- Remove contact lenses until resolved
- Do NOT squeeze or pop the lump
- Keep hands and face clean
- Use separate towels and pillowcases

Expected Recovery Time

- **Stye**: Should improve in 3-5 days, resolve in 7-10 days
- **Chalazion**: May take 4-6 weeks to resolve

When to See Doctor Despite Home Care

- Not improving after 48 hours (stye) or 2 weeks (chalazion)
- Getting worse instead of better
- Any warning signs develop

Prevention Tips

Daily Habits

- Don't rub eyes with unwashed hands
- Remove all eye makeup before bed
- Replace mascara every 3 months
- Don't share towels, makeup, or eye products
- Clean contact lenses properly
- Wash pillowcases regularly

For Frequent Recurrence

- Daily eyelid hygiene routine (warm compress + cleaning)
- Manage underlying conditions (rosacea, dandruff, diabetes)
- Consider omega-3 supplements
- See eye doctor for long-term prevention plan

Important Notes

This is a self-assessment guide only and does not replace professional medical advice. When in doubt, consult an eye doctor.

Do not delay emergency care if you have severe symptoms. Vision-threatening conditions require immediate attention.

Special populations:

- **Children**: See doctor for any eyelid infection
- **Pregnant women**: Warm compresses are safe; consult doctor before using medications
- **Diabetic patients**: Lower threshold for seeing doctor due to higher infection risk
- **Contact lens wearers**: Always see doctor for any red eye or eyelid infection

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For the detailed version of this guide with comprehensive explanations, refer to the complete Stye & Chalazion Self-Assessment Guide.